Canon PIXMA G1010 Printer Driver for Mac

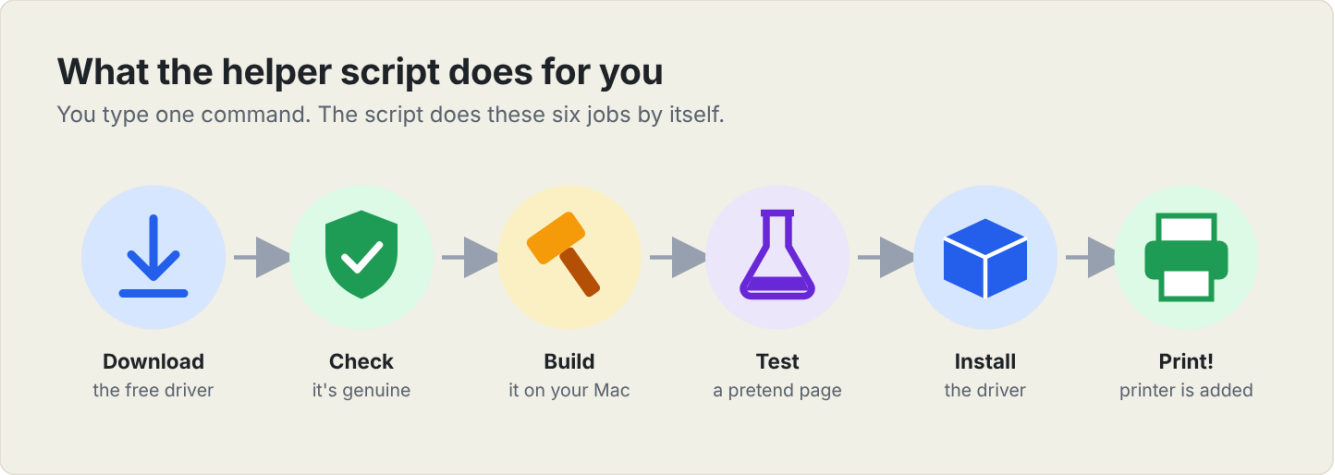
A step-by-step guide with pictures that anyone can follow

> 🖼️ The pictures in this guide are **drawings** to show you what to look for. Your screen may look a little different, but the buttons and words will be the same.

📖 What is this?

Your **Canon PIXMA G1010** printer works with Windows computers, but Canon never made a driver for Mac. A **driver** is a small program that teaches the computer how to talk to the printer. Without one, your Mac doesn't know how to print on it.

This folder gives you a free, open-source driver called **Gutenprint**, set up for the G1010, and a **helper script** that installs it for you. You type one command in Terminal, and the script does these six jobs by itself:



> ℹ️ The Canon Windows file (`win-g1010-…exe`) is **not used**. Windows drivers can't run on a Mac, so you can ignore or delete that file.

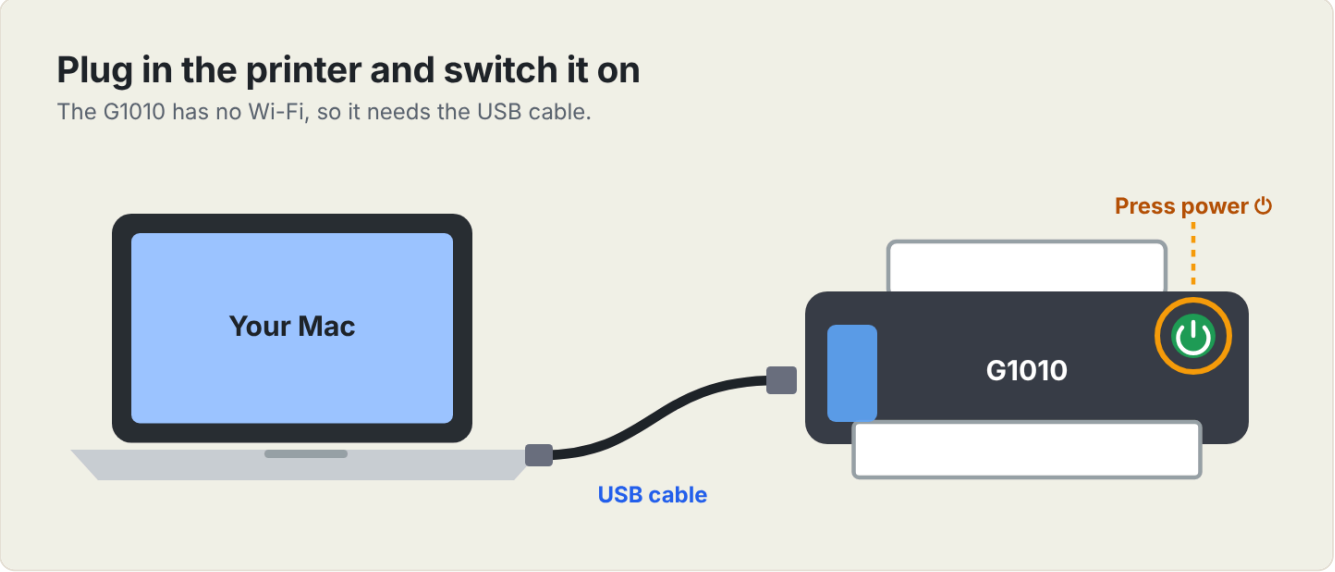
✅ Before you start: what you need

You need	Why
A Mac with an **Apple chip** (M1, M2, M3, M4, ...) running **macOS 11 or newer**	The driver is built for these Macs
The **Canon G1010** printer, with ink and paper	So you can print
The printer's **USB cable**	The G1010 has no Wi-Fi, so it must be plugged in
Your **Mac login password**	macOS asks for it before installing anything

How to check which Mac you have: click the Apple menu in the top-left corner of the screen → **About This Mac**. Next to **Chip** it should say **Apple M...**.

🔌 First: connect the printer

1. Plug the USB cable into the printer and into your Mac. If your Mac only has the small oval USB-C ports, use a USB-C adapter.
2. Press the printer's **power button** ⏻ and wait until the light stops blinking.



> 💡 If you forget, don't worry. The driver still installs, and you can add the printer afterwards (see **"Add the printer by hand"**).

🛠️ Install the driver

You'll need an **internet connection** and about **15 minutes**. Most of that is waiting while your Mac builds the driver.

Step 1. Put the files in one folder

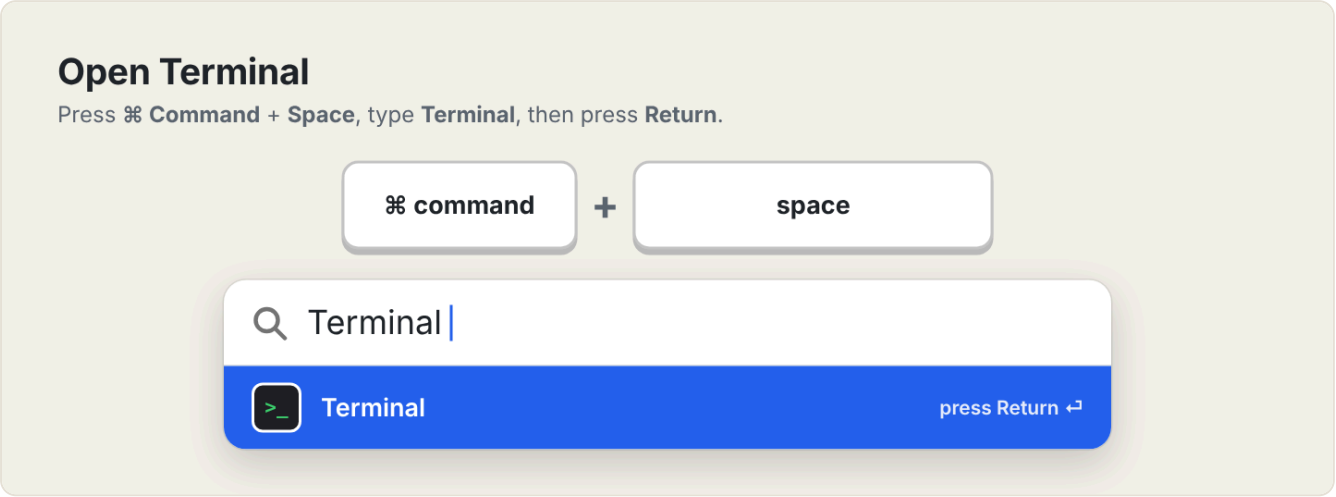
You should have these files:

- `build-g1010-mac-driver.sh` (the helper script)
- `README.md` (this guide) and the `images` folder
- Open **Finder**.
- Make a new folder, for example on your Desktop, called `G1010 printer driver`.
- Move all the files into that folder.

Step 2. Open Terminal

Terminal is an app where you type instructions for your Mac. Nothing to worry about: you'll only type what this guide tells you.

1. Press ⌘ **Command + Space** together. A search bar appears.
2. Type `Terminal`.
3. Press **Return** ⏎.

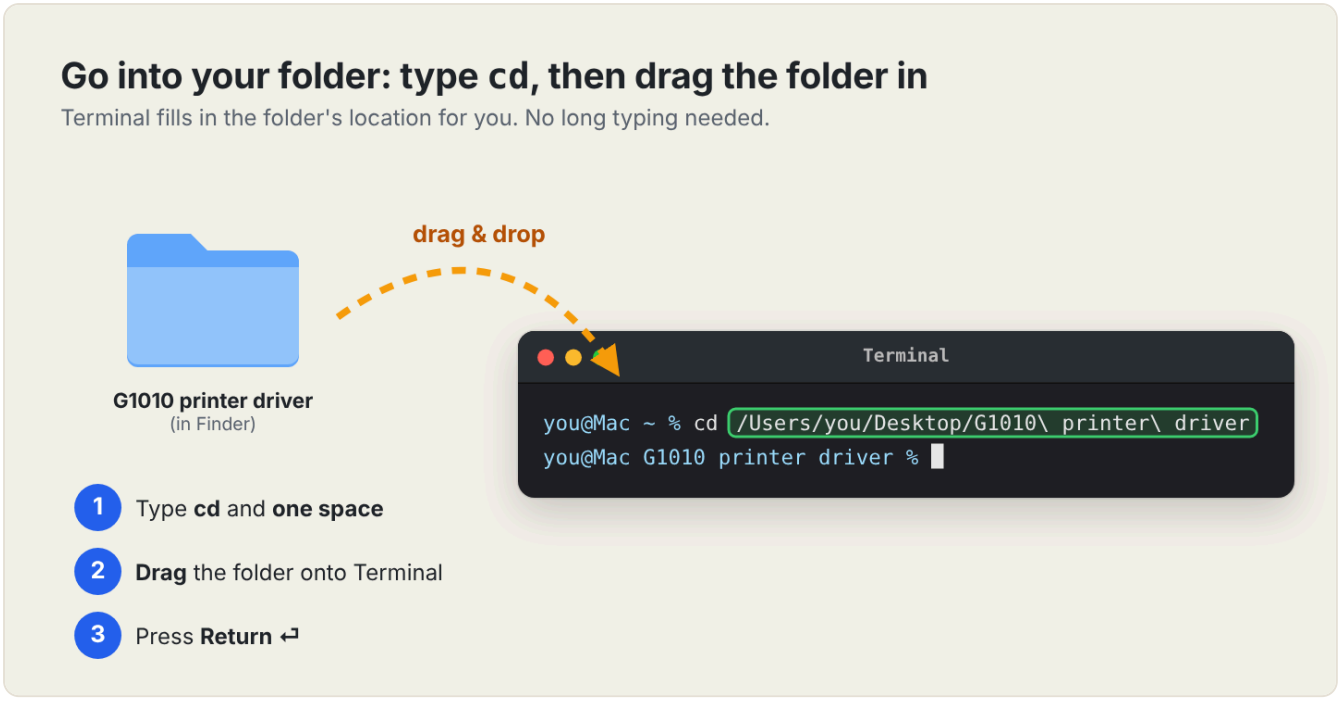


A window opens with a line ending in `%`. That's where you type.

Step 3. Tell Terminal where your folder is

The easiest way is to **drag the folder** into Terminal:

1. In Terminal, type `cd` followed by **one space**. Don't press Return yet.
2. Go to **Finder** and **drag the `G1010 printer driver` folder** onto the Terminal window, then let go. Terminal fills in the folder's location.
3. Now press **Return** ⏎.



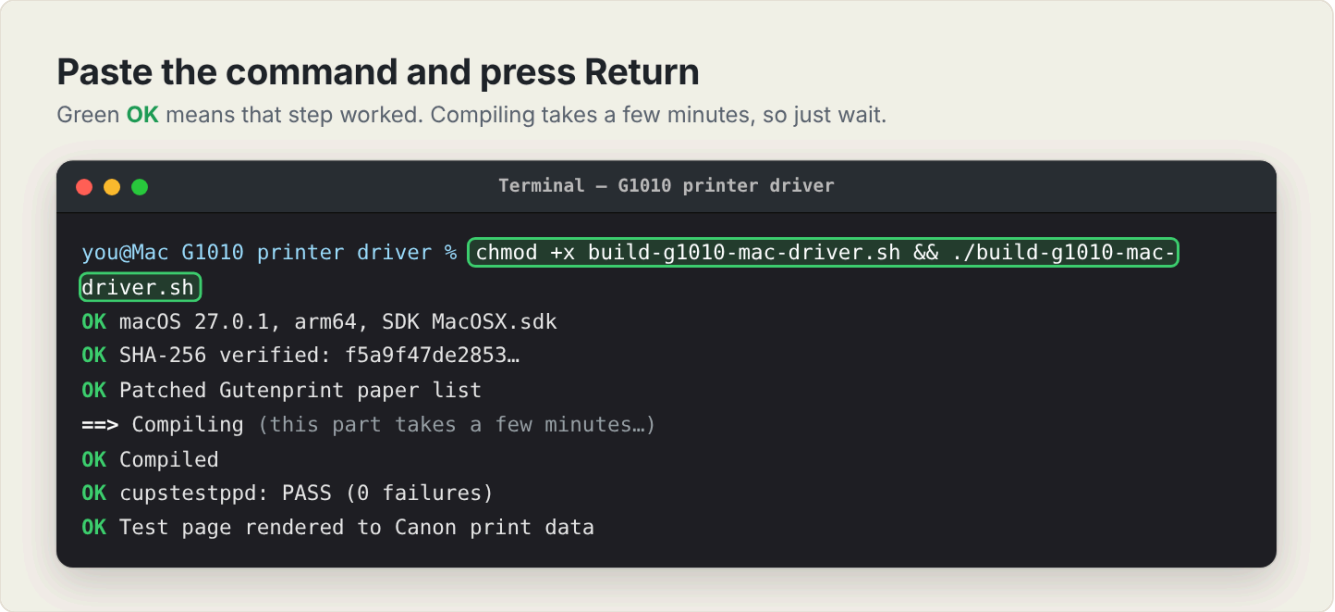
The line ending in `%` should now show your folder name: `you@Mac G1010 printer driver %` ✅

Step 4. Run the helper script

Type (or copy and paste) this line exactly, then press **Return** ⏎:

```
chmod +x build-g1010-mac-driver.sh && ./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh
```

What does that mean? - `chmod +x …` gives the script permission to run. - `./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh` starts the script.

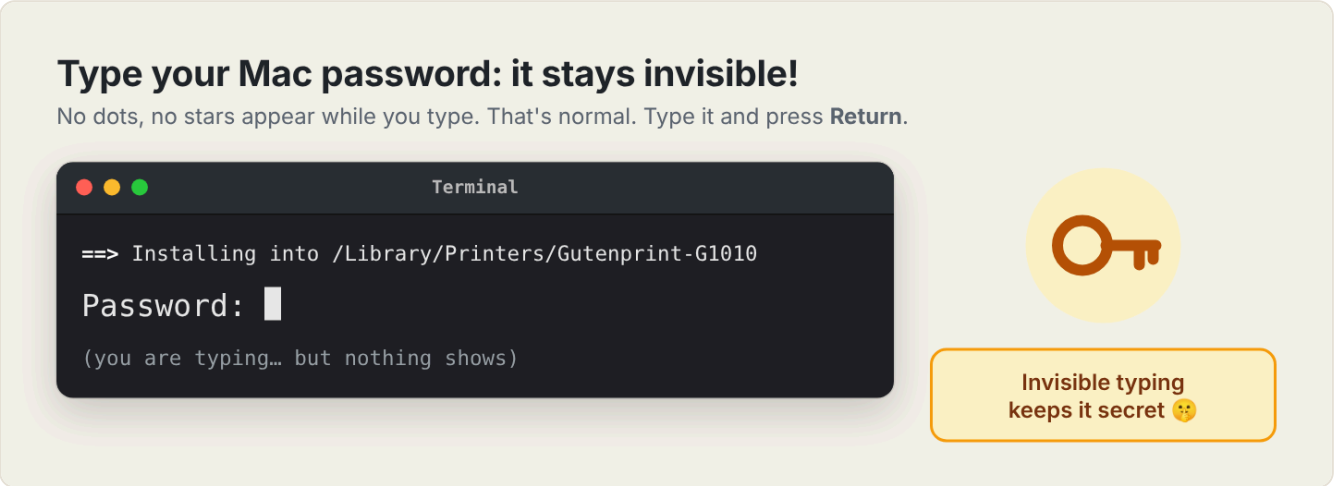


Green **OK** means that step worked. ⏳ **Compiling** takes a few minutes. That's normal, so just wait.

> **A pop-up asks to install "Command Line Tools"?** These are Apple's free building tools. Click **Install**, then **Agree**, and wait until it finishes (5 to 20 minutes). Then go back to Terminal, press the ↑ **Up arrow** key to bring the command back, and press **Return**.

Step 5. Type your password 🔑

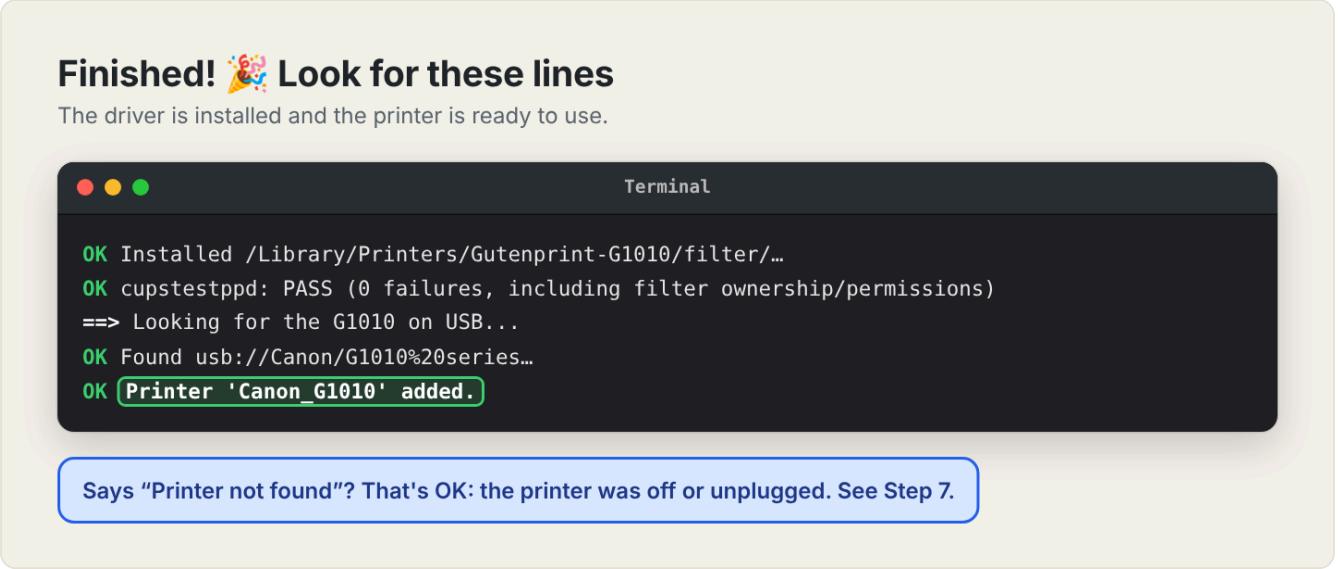
When you see `Password:`, type your **Mac login password** and press **Return**.



> ⚠️ **Nothing appears while you type the password. No dots, no stars.** That's normal and keeps your password secret. Just type it carefully and press Return.

Step 6. The finish line 🎉

Look for **"Printer 'Canon_G1010' added."** at the end:



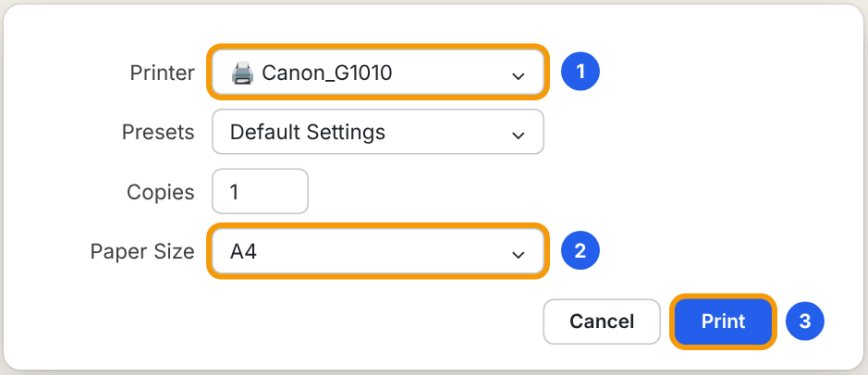
✅ **Done!** If it says **"Printer not found"**, the printer was unplugged or off. Go to **"➕ Add the printer by hand"**.

🖨️ Print a test page

1. Open any document, for example in **TextEdit**, **Preview** or **Pages**.
2. Press ⌘ **Command + P**.
3. Next to **Printer**, choose **Canon_G1010**.
4. Next to **Paper Size**, choose **A4** (or the size of paper you loaded).
5. Click **Print**.

Print something: press ⌘ Command + P

Choose **Canon_G1010**, pick your paper size, then click **Print**.



The printer should wake up and print. 🎉

➕ Add the printer by hand (only if needed)

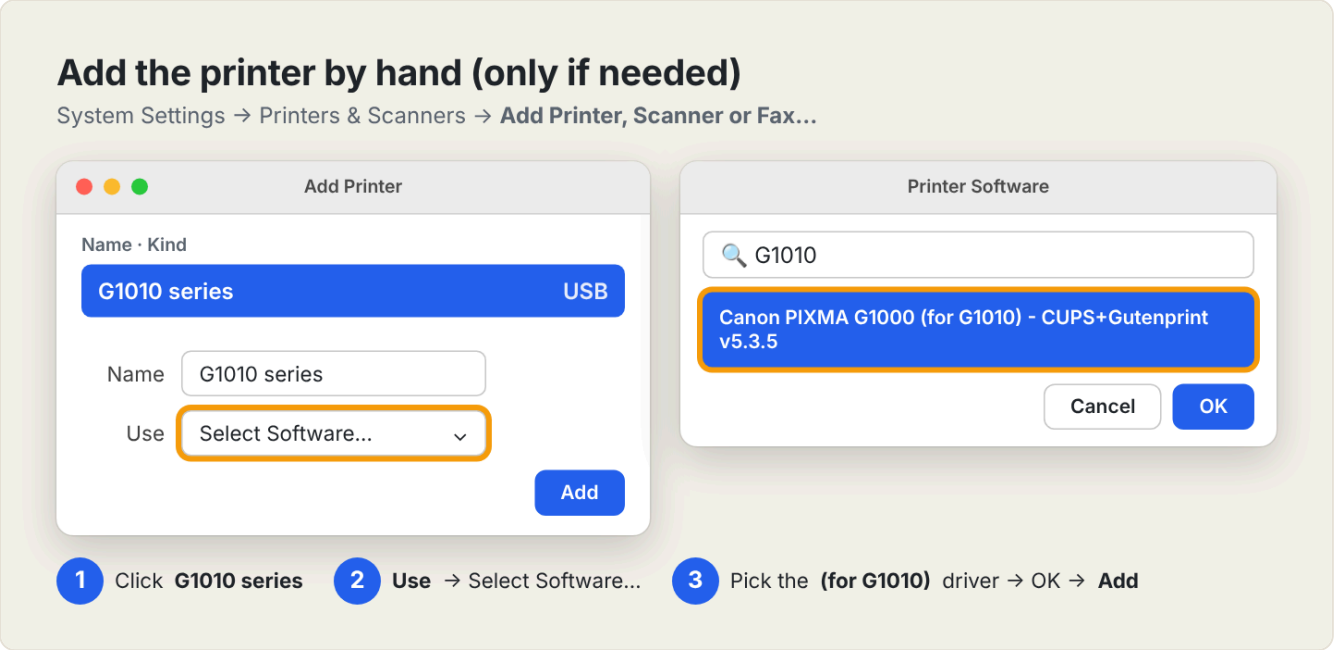
Do this if the printer wasn't plugged in during the install, or doesn't appear when you press ⌘P.

Easiest: let the script do it (if you have the script). Plug in and switch on the printer, then in Terminal, inside your folder (see **Step 3**), type:

```
./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh add-printer
```

Or use System Settings:

1. Apple menu → **System Settings** → **Printers & Scanners**.
2. Click **Add Printer, Scanner or Fax…**
3. Click **G1010 series** in the list.
4. Next to **Use**, choose **Select Software…**
5. Type `G1010` in the search box and pick **Canon PIXMA G1000 (for G1010) - CUPS+Gutenprint v5.3.5**.
6. Click **OK**, then **Add**.



❓ **Why does it say "G1000"?** The G1010 uses the same printing commands as the Canon G1000, so the G1000 driver works for it. The "(for G1010)" label shows it was set up for your printer.

🗑️ How to remove the driver

In Terminal, inside your folder (see **Step 3**), type:

```
./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh uninstall
```

Type your password when asked. This removes the printer, the driver and everything it added. Nothing else on your Mac is touched.

🛟 Help! Something went wrong

What you see	What it means	What to do
`zsh: permission denied: ./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh`	The script isn't allowed to run yet	Run `chmod +x build-g1010-mac-driver.sh` first, then try again
`no such file or directory`	Terminal isn't in your folder	Do **Step 3** again (type `cd`, a space, drag the folder in)

What you see	What it means	What to do
A pop-up about **Command Line Tools**	Apple's building tools aren't installed yet	Click **Install**, wait until it finishes, then run the command again
`Run this as your normal user (not with sudo)`	You typed `sudo` in front of the command	Run it **without** `sudo`. The script asks for your password itself
`Sorry, try again.` after typing your password	Wrong password	Type it again slowly (remember, it stays invisible)
`Download failed from all mirrors`	No internet, or the download site is down	Check Wi-Fi and try again later
`SHA-256 mismatch` or `Size mismatch`	The download was damaged or changed	The script already deleted it for safety. Just run it again
`Compile failed` or `configure failed`	The build hit a problem	Take a screenshot and ask for help. Also run `tail -30 ~/g1010-driver-build/logs/make.log` and screenshot that
`Printer not found`	Printer unplugged or off	Plug it in, switch it on, then see **"Add the printer by hand"**
The printer isn't listed when you press ⌘P	The printer wasn't added	See **"Add the printer by hand"**
Print job sits in the queue and nothing happens	Printer asleep or cable loose	Check the cable and power. In **System Settings → Printers & Scanners → Canon_G1010 → Printer Queue...**, click **Resume** ▶ if it's paused
Page prints but colours look odd or faded	Ink low or print head blocked	Fill the ink tanks and clean the print head with the printer's own buttons (see your Canon manual)
Page prints garbled (strange symbols)	The driver isn't working with this printer	See **"If it doesn't work at all"** below

Where are the log files?

The helper script keeps its notes in `~/g1010-driver-build/logs/` (`~` means your home folder). If you ask someone for help, screenshots of the screen and these logs help a lot.

🛡️ Is this safe?

Yes. The helper script was made to be careful:

- 🔒 **The driver comes only from the official Gutenprint 5.3.5**, downloaded over a secure HTTPS connection.
- 🧾 **The download's "fingerprint" is checked.** This is a SHA-256 checksum, like a seal on a jar. It must match the one published by two separate, trusted sources (MacPorts and NixOS). If it doesn't match, the script **stops and deletes the file**.
- 🧰 **Only Apple's own tools are used** to build the driver. Other software you may have installed (like Homebrew) is ignored.
- 🙋 **Your password is asked for only when it must be**: to copy the driver into the system printer folder and to add the printer.
- 🧪 **Everything is tested.** The driver "prints" a test page into a file and checks it, before and after installing. Apple's printer-file checker (`cupstestppd`) must pass with **0 failures**. If a check fails after installing, the script **undoes the install**.
- 📍 **It installs to just two places**, and both are removed completely by uninstall:
- `/Library/Printers/Gutenprint-G1010/`
- `/Library/Printers/PPDs/Contents/Resources/Canon-G1010-Gutenprint.ppd.gz`

⚠️ Good to know

- **This is not an official Canon driver.** Canon doesn't support the G1010 on Mac. Gutenprint is a respected free driver used on Mac and Linux for many years, but Gutenprint itself calls its G-series support **"experimental"**.
- **Normal printing works:** documents, text, pictures on plain paper.
- **Colours may look a little different** from printing on Windows.
- **Ink levels and head cleaning can't be done from the Mac.** Use the buttons on the printer instead (see your Canon manual).
- **macOS updates:** the driver normally keeps working. If printing stops after a big macOS update, run the script again.

If it doesn't work at all

If pages never print or always come out garbled, a backup plan is to run Windows inside your Mac, with an app like **Parallels Desktop** or **UTM**. You then connect the printer to Windows and use Canon's original Windows driver.

📚 Words used in this guide

Word	Meaning
Driver	A small program that lets the computer talk to the printer
Terminal	A Mac app where you type instructions
Script	A file of instructions the computer follows step by step
Gutenprint	A free, open-source printer driver project
Build / compile	Turning a program's written code into something the Mac can run
PPD	A small "description" file that tells macOS what the printer can do (paper sizes, quality, ...)
Filter	The part of the driver that turns your page into dots of ink
sudo	Tells the Mac "do this as the administrator". It asks for your password
SHA-256 / checksum	A unique fingerprint of a file, used to prove it hasn't been changed
USB	The cable connection between the printer and your Mac

⚡ Quick reference (for next time)

I want to...	Do this
Build and install the driver	`./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh`
Add the printer	`./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh add-printer`
Remove the driver	`./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh uninstall`
See the script's built-in help	`./build-g1010-mac-driver.sh --help`

Driver: Gutenprint 5.3.5 (free software, GPL licence), built for the Canon PIXMA G1010. Not made or supported by Canon.

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